
Advocacy

What advocacy is

Advocacy is an independent service aimed at helping people understand their rights and express their views. It helps people, especially the most vulnerable, to be involved in the decisions that affect their lives.

Nottinghamshire County Council and Nottingham City Council jointly commissioned an advocacy service which is delivered by POhWER and is known as Your Voice, Your Choice.

The service has been designed to fulfil the local authority's statutory requirements in relation to advocacy.

Follow the links below to find out more about the service:

- [Independent Mental Health Advocates \(IMHA\)](#)
- [Independent Mental Capacity Advocates \(IMCA\)](#)
- [Relevant persons representatives \(RPRs\)](#)
- [Independent Complaints Advocates \(ICA's\)](#)
- [Care Act Advocates.](#)

In addition to the statutory requirements listed above, POhWER also delivers advocacy to people with a learning disability and/or autism at risk of being admitted to, or already in, hospital for assessment and treatment.

They also deliver a Co-Production Service in the County which will support and enable people with lived experience to feed into the Local Account. Further details of this service can be obtained from <https://www.nottinghamshire.gov.uk/care/adult-social-care/co-production>

What an advocate does

An advocate will help people who, because of disability, illness, social exclusion and other challenges, find it difficult to express their views or get the support they need.

POhWER are working in partnership with Nottingham Deaf Society who are providing a D/deaf advocate to enable communication in British Sign Language.

The role of an advocate depends on the persons situation and the support they want.

An advocate can:

- listen to the persons views and concerns
- help people explore their options and rights
- provide information to help a person make informed decisions
- help someone contact relevant people, or contact them on their behalf
- accompany a person and support them in meetings or appointments.

An advocate will not:

- give their personal opinion
- solve problems and make decisions for someone
- make judgements about people.

How to refer into the service?

Referral forms can be downloaded via the following link

<https://www.pohwer.net/make-a-referral> and once completed should be sent to Y.YourChoice@pohwer.net

To enable POhWER to triage a referral appropriately it is essential that all sections of the forms are completed. This might include details of the Decision Maker, dates of Mental Capacity assessments, the referrer's contact details or any planned meeting/decision dates. This this will help POhWER triage correctly and ensure delays are not caused because they have to request additional information.

If you wish to talk to someone at POhWER you can call 0300 020 0093
